

Sandy beaches are where you find sea holly. It is usually in the sand dunes, as it likes to shelter there, out of the wind. With blue leaves and purple flowers, sea holly is hard to miss. Being a seaside plant is not easy, because the salty air is bad for leaves and makes them dry out. Sea holly has tough, waxy leaves that keep water in.

Sea holly's jagged edges keep nibbling animals away, especially from the tight balls of flowers. All sharp and spiky, it may remind you of holly trees. However, you might be surprised to learn which family of plants it belongs to – the carrot family!

Sea holly, Europe

